

Sex

Sex means different things to different people. In general, it's an act of physical intimacy between two people that involves their genitals. It can be very pleasurable and can be an important element of any romantic relationship.

Sex and consent

Most countries have laws that relate to sex, to protect people's rights and to safeguard young or vulnerable people. It's against the law to make someone have sex if they don't want to and haven't given their consent. Most countries have a legal age of consent – the age at which the law says a person is able to consent to having sex. In the UK this is 16 years of age.

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GOOD TO KNOW

Getting consent

Talk to each other and listen carefully to ensure you're both comfortable and want to continue. It's a good sign if you can each tell the other when you like what they're doing. It's time to stop if someone expresses uncertainty, or pain, and pulls away.

Vaginal sex

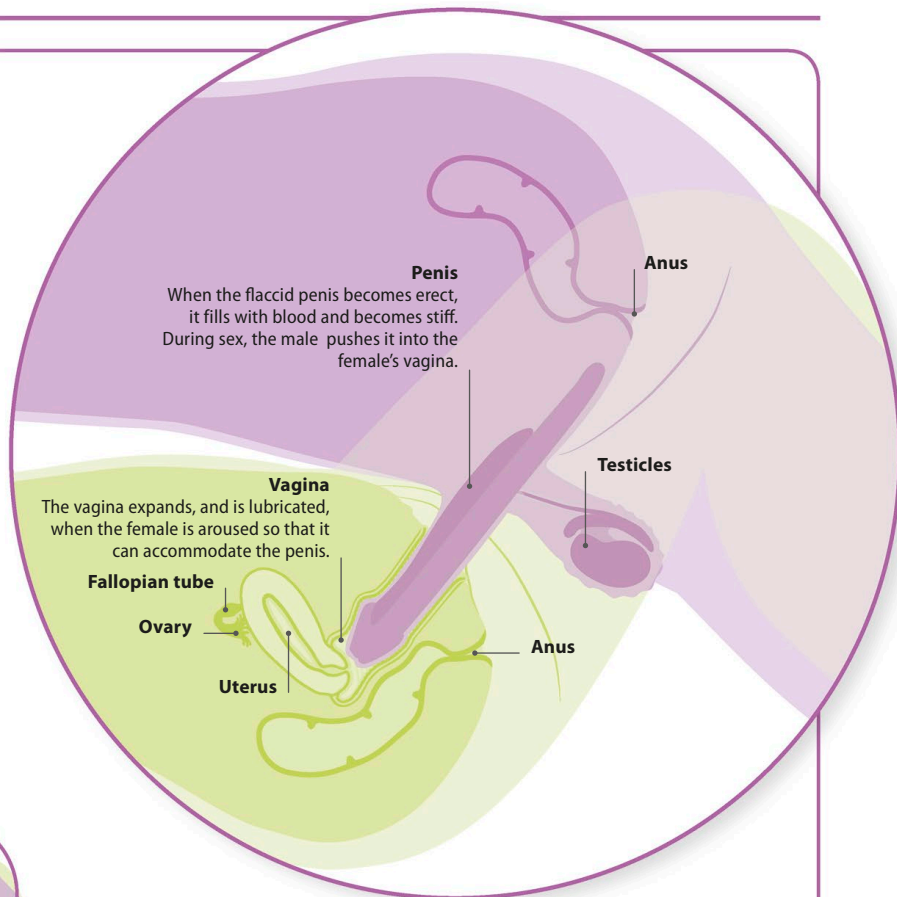
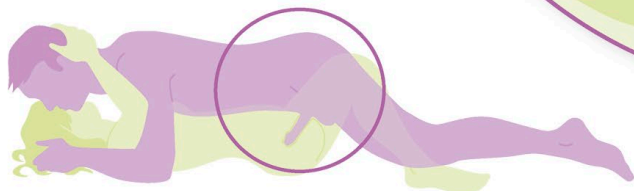
Vaginal sex occurs when a male inserts his erect penis into a female's vagina. Once the penis is inside the vagina, it is withdrawn partially then fully inserted again in a rhythm. This repeated motion is pleasurable and may stimulate one or both partners to orgasm.

Both the male and female should be aroused before vaginal sex – otherwise it can be uncomfortable. Arousal ensures that the penis is erect and hard and that the vagina is lubricated.

When the male reaches orgasm, he will ejaculate (release semen) into the vagina, if the sex is unprotected. Some sperm from his semen could reach an egg and pregnancy might occur.

▽ Vaginal sex

Vaginal sex between males and females is often simply referred to as "sex". It is the only type of sex that can result in pregnancy.



△ Pleasurable feelings

The genitals are full of highly sensitive nerve endings, which, when stimulated, can make a person feel aroused.